Working with VS Code and Github Copilot for non technical users

Prerequisites

Before proceeding, make sure you have completed all steps in the **Technical Setup Instructions** document.

Verification Checklist

Confirm that all of the following requirements are met:

- I have the **DEV role** approved in REDIM.
- I have **Visual Studio Code (VS Code)** installed on my computer.
- I am logged into Github through my VS Code with the Sporka Github profile.
- I have **GitHub Copilot** working in VS Code.
    - Required REDIM role: `CSIN\vcs_github_copilot`
    - Business or Enterprise plan required
- I have **Node.js version 22 or newer** installed.
- I have access to the **SPOCK repository**.
    - Required REDIM role: `CSIN\GHB_DEV_SPOCK_WRITE`
- I have cloned the repository and can open it locally in VS Code.

> ***Important:*** *Continue only after all items above have been completed.*

Setting Up the SPOCK Discovery Workflow

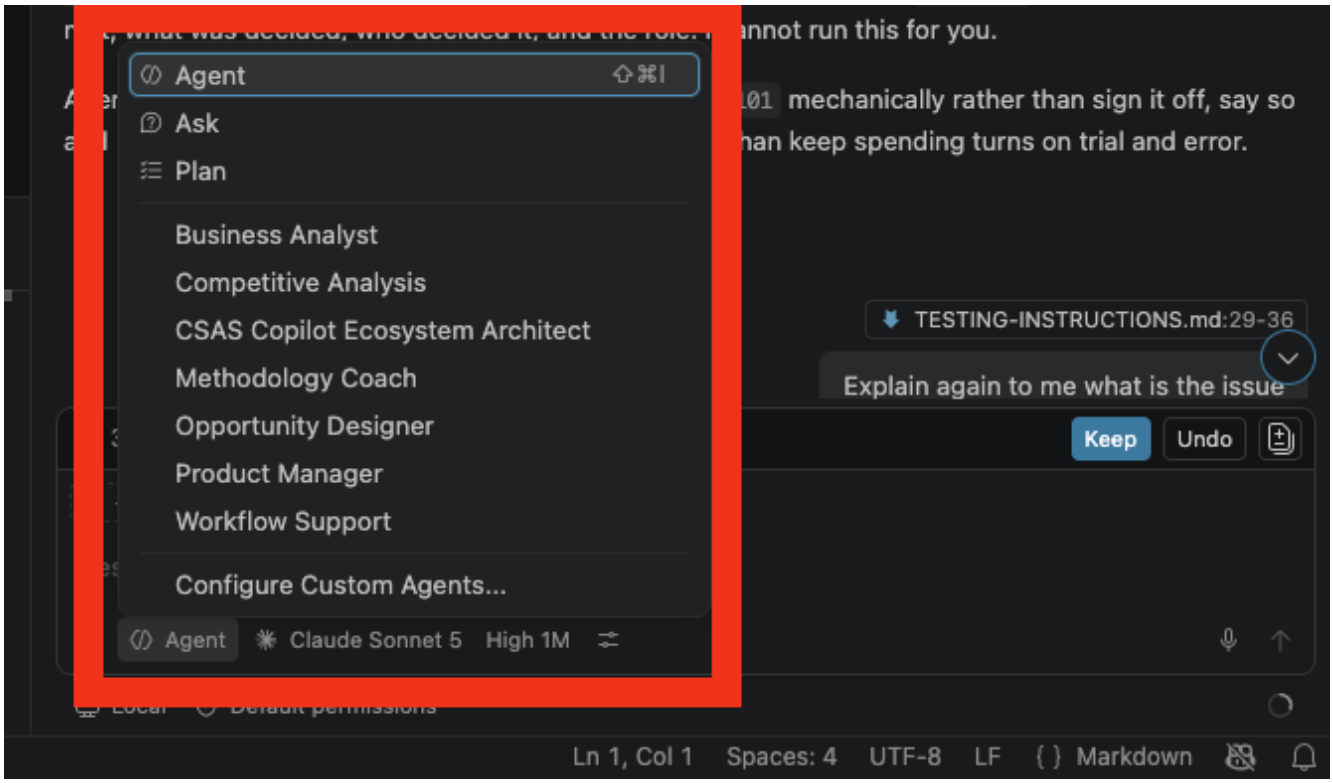
Step 1: Open the Agent Picker

1. Open VS Code.
2. Open the GitHub Copilot chat.
3. Click the **Agent Picker** icon.

You should see:

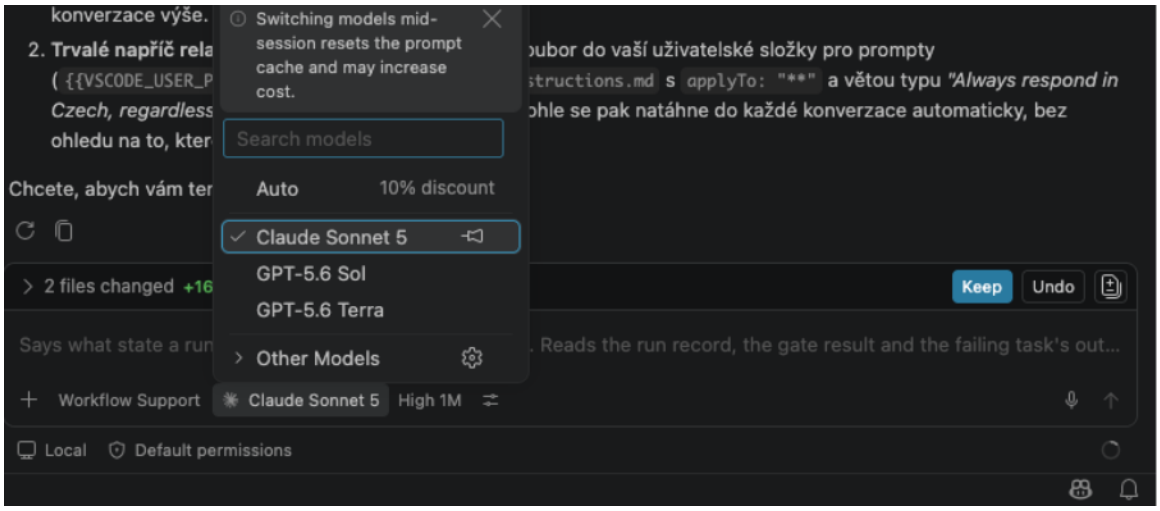
- Agent
- Ask
- Plan
- 6 SPOCK agents
- CSAS Copilot Ecosystem Architect





Step 2: Select the AI Model

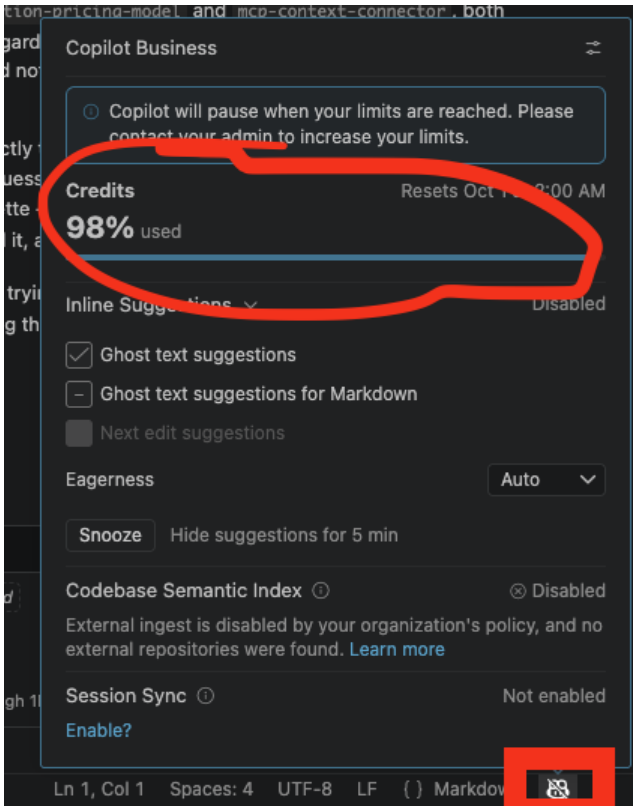
1. Open the model selector.
2. Select **Claude Sonnet 5**.



Step 3: Check Available Credits

Before starting your workflow:

1. Look at the bottom-right corner of VS Code.
2. Locate the **Copilot icon** next to the notification (bell) icon.
3. Verify that you have sufficient credits available.

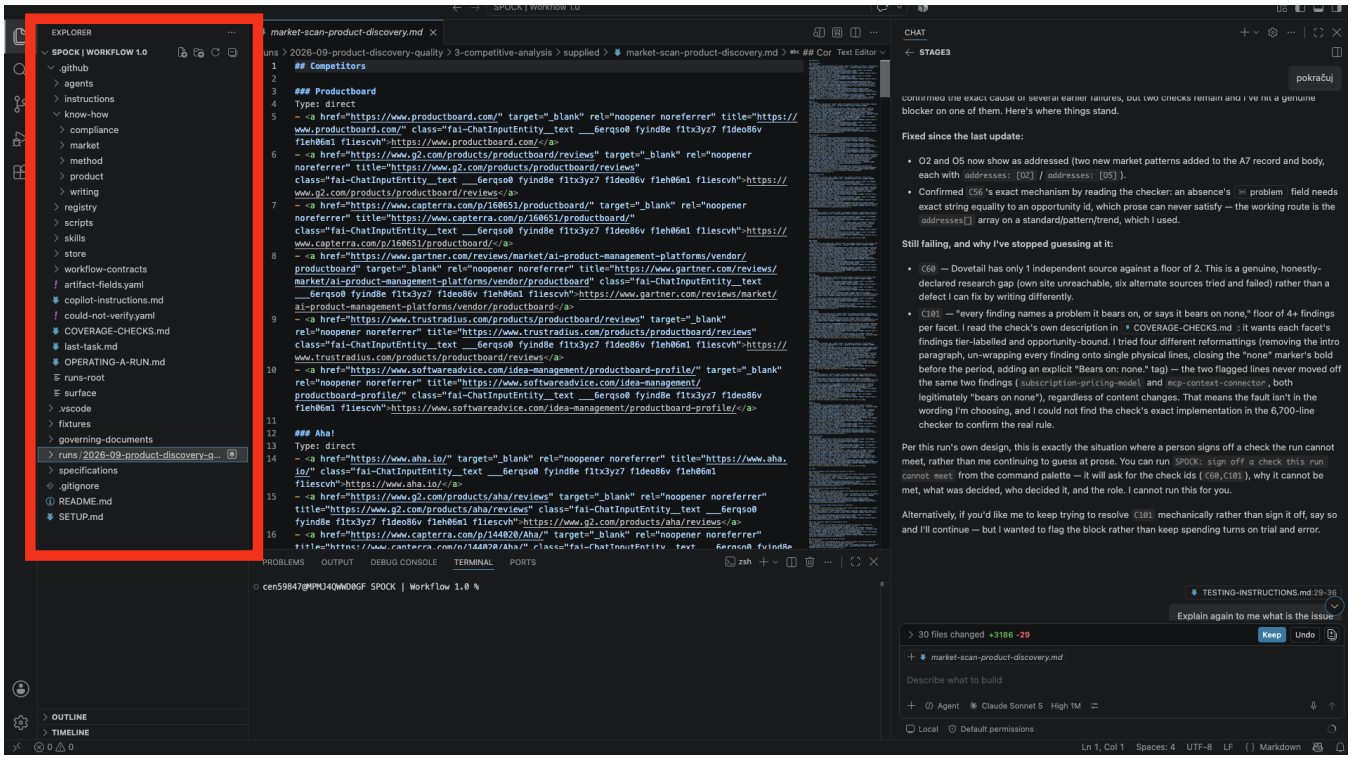


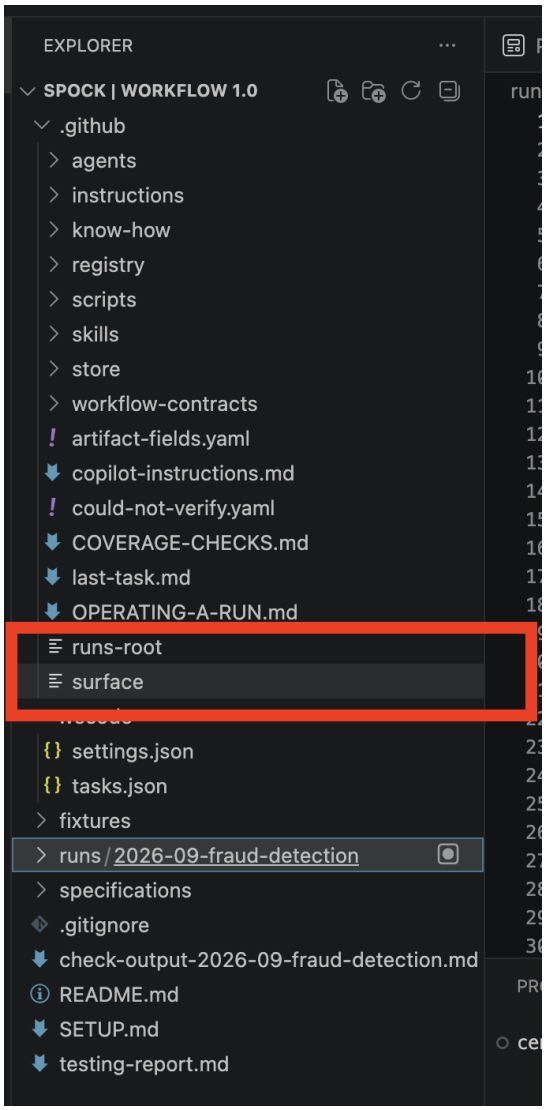
Step 4: Configure the Surface File

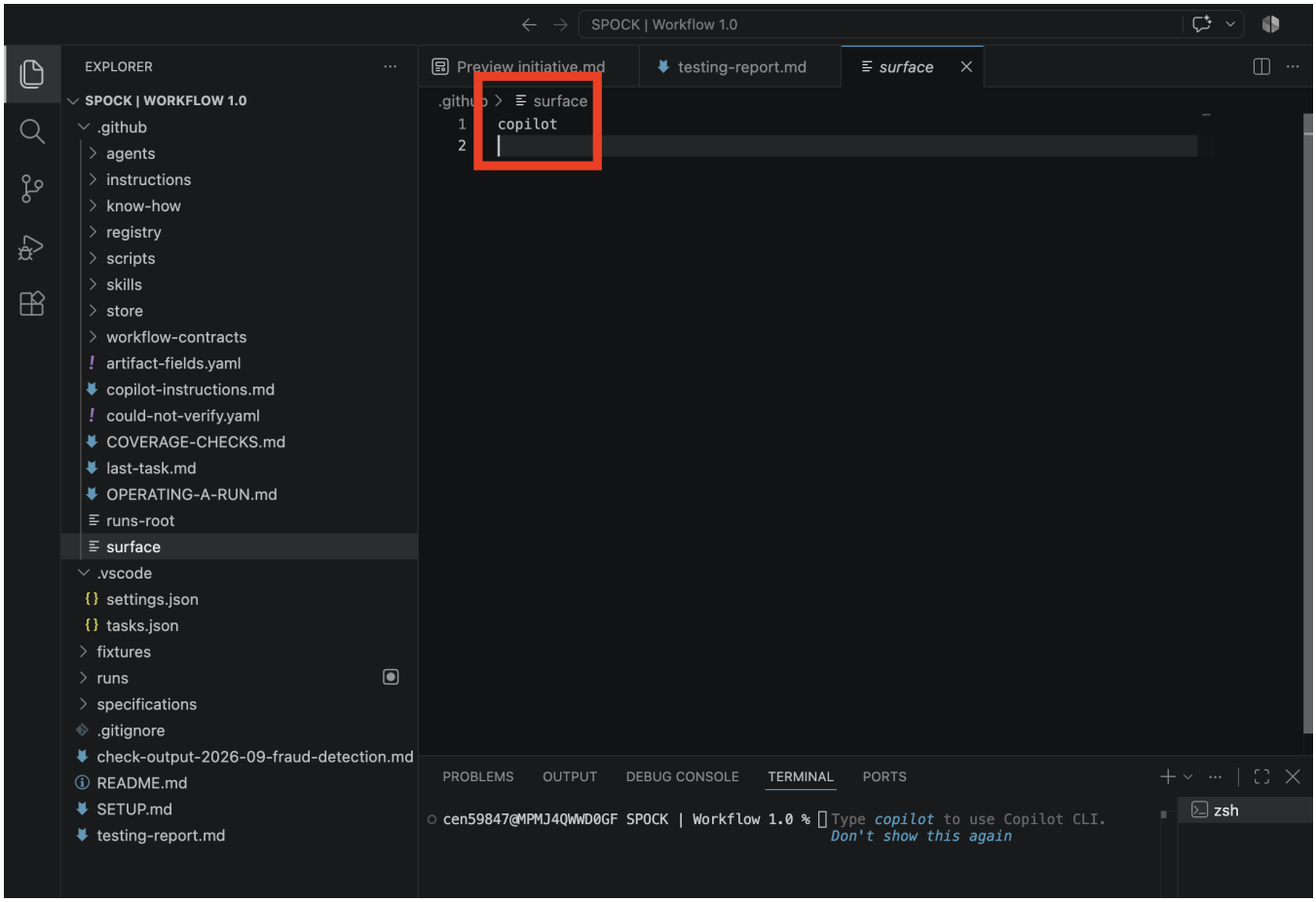
Before running any SPOCK workflow:

1. In the Explorer panel on the left, locate the file named **surface**.
2. Open the file.
3. Find the value: "unset" Replace it with: "copilot"

1. Save the file:
   - **macOS:** `+ S`
   - **Windows:** `Ctrl + S`


EXPLORER
SPOCK | WORKFLOW 1.0
.github
agents
instructions
know-how
compliance
market
method
product
writing
registry
scripts
skills
store
workflow-contracts
artifact-fields.yaml
copilot-instructions.md
could-not-verify.yaml
COVERAGE-CHECKS.md
last-task.md
OPERATING-A-RUN.md
runs-root
surface
.vscode
fixtures
governing-documents
runs / 2026-09-product-discovery-q...
specifications
.gitignore
README.md
SETUP.md
OUTLINE
TIMELINE
market-scan-product-discovery.md
Competitors
Productboard
Type: direct
Aha!
Type: direct
PROBLEMS
OUTPUT
DEBUG CONSOLE
TERMINAL
PORTS
cen59847@MPMJ4QWWD0GF SPOCK | Workflow 1.0 %
CHAT
STAGES
pokračuj
Fixed since the last update:
O2 and O5 now show as addressed (two new market patterns added to the A7 record and body, each with addresses: [O2] / addresses: [O5]).
Confirmed C56 's exact mechanism by reading the checker: an absence's problem field needs exact string equality to an opportunity id, which prose can never satisfy — the working route is the addresses[] array on a standard/pattern/trend, which I used.
Still failing, and why I've stopped guessing at it:
C60 — Dovetail has only 1 independent source against a floor of 2. This is a genuine, honestly-declared research gap (own site unreachable, six alternate sources tried and failed) rather than a defect I can fix by writing differently.
C101 — "every finding names a problem it bears on, or says it bears on none," floor of 4+ findings per facet. I read the check's own description in COVERAGE-CHECKS.md : it wants each facet's findings tier-labelled and opportunity-bound. I tried four different reformattings (removing the intro paragraph, un-wrapping every finding onto single physical lines, closing the "none" marker's bold before the period, adding an explicit "Bears on: none." tag) — the two flagged lines never moved off the same two findings (subscription-pricing-model and mcp-context-connector , both legitimately "bears on none"), regardless of content changes. That means the fault isn't in the wording I'm choosing, and I could not find the check's exact implementation in the 6,700-line checker to confirm the real rule.
Per this run's own design, this is exactly the situation where a person signs off a check the run cannot meet, rather than me continuing to guess at prose. You can run SPOCK: sign off a check this run cannot meet from the command palette — it will ask for the check ids (C60,C101), why it cannot be met, what was decided, who decided it, and the role. I cannot run this for you.
Alternatively, if you'd like me to keep trying to resolve C101 mechanically rather than sign it off, say so and I'll continue — but I wanted to flag the block rather than keep spending turns on trial and error.
TESTING-INSTRUCTIONS.md:29-36
Explain again to me what is the issue
30 files changed +3186 -29
Keep
Undo
market-scan-product-discovery.md
Describe what to build
Agent
Claude Sonnet 5
High 1M
Local
Default permissions
Ln 1, Col 1
Spaces: 4
UTF-8
LF
Markdown


EXPLORER
SPOCK | WORKFLOW 1.0
.github
agents
instructions
know-how
registry
scripts
skills
store
workflow-contracts
artifact-fields.yaml
copilot-instructions.md
could-not-verify.yaml
COVERAGE-CHECKS.md
last-task.md
OPERATING-A-RUN.md
runs-root
surface
settings.json
tasks.json
fixtures
runs / 2026-09-fraud-detection
specifications
.gitignore
check-output-2026-09-fraud-detection.md
README.md
SETUP.md
testing-report.md

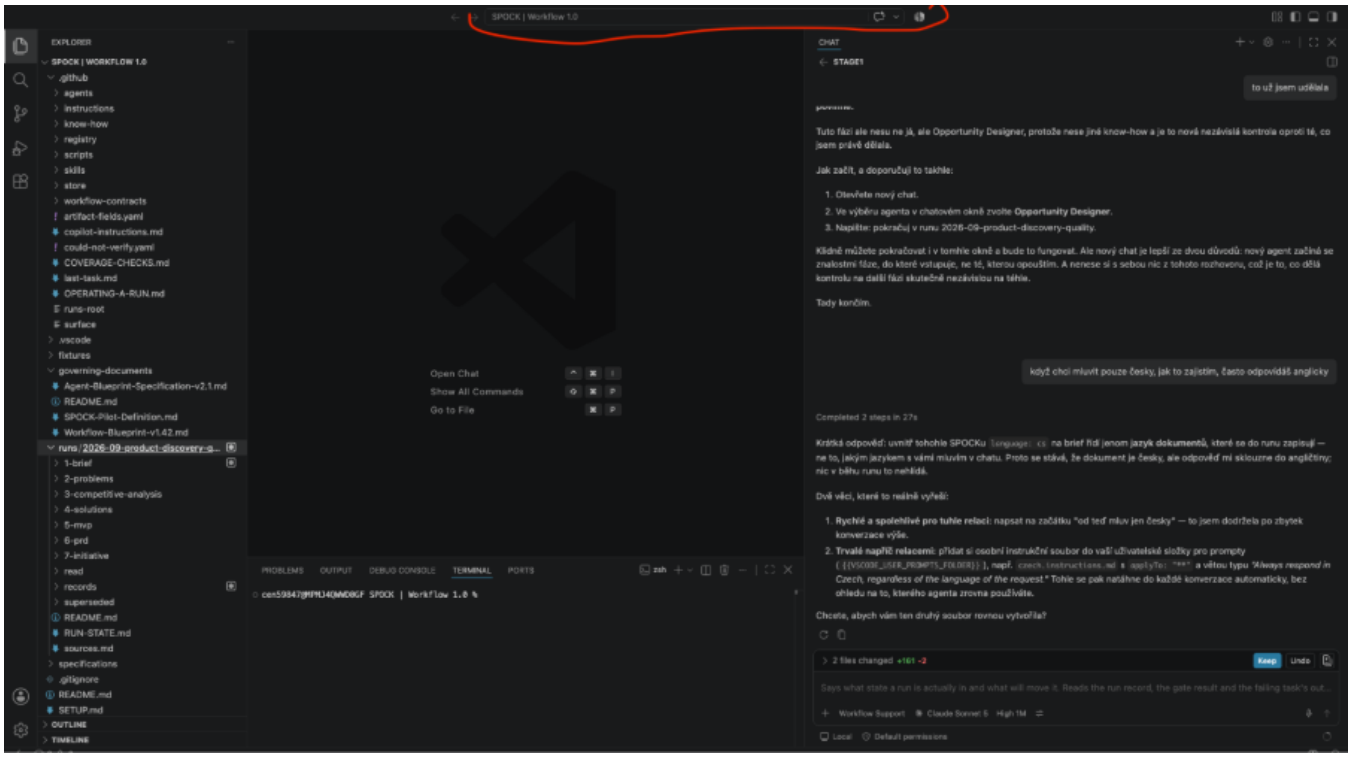


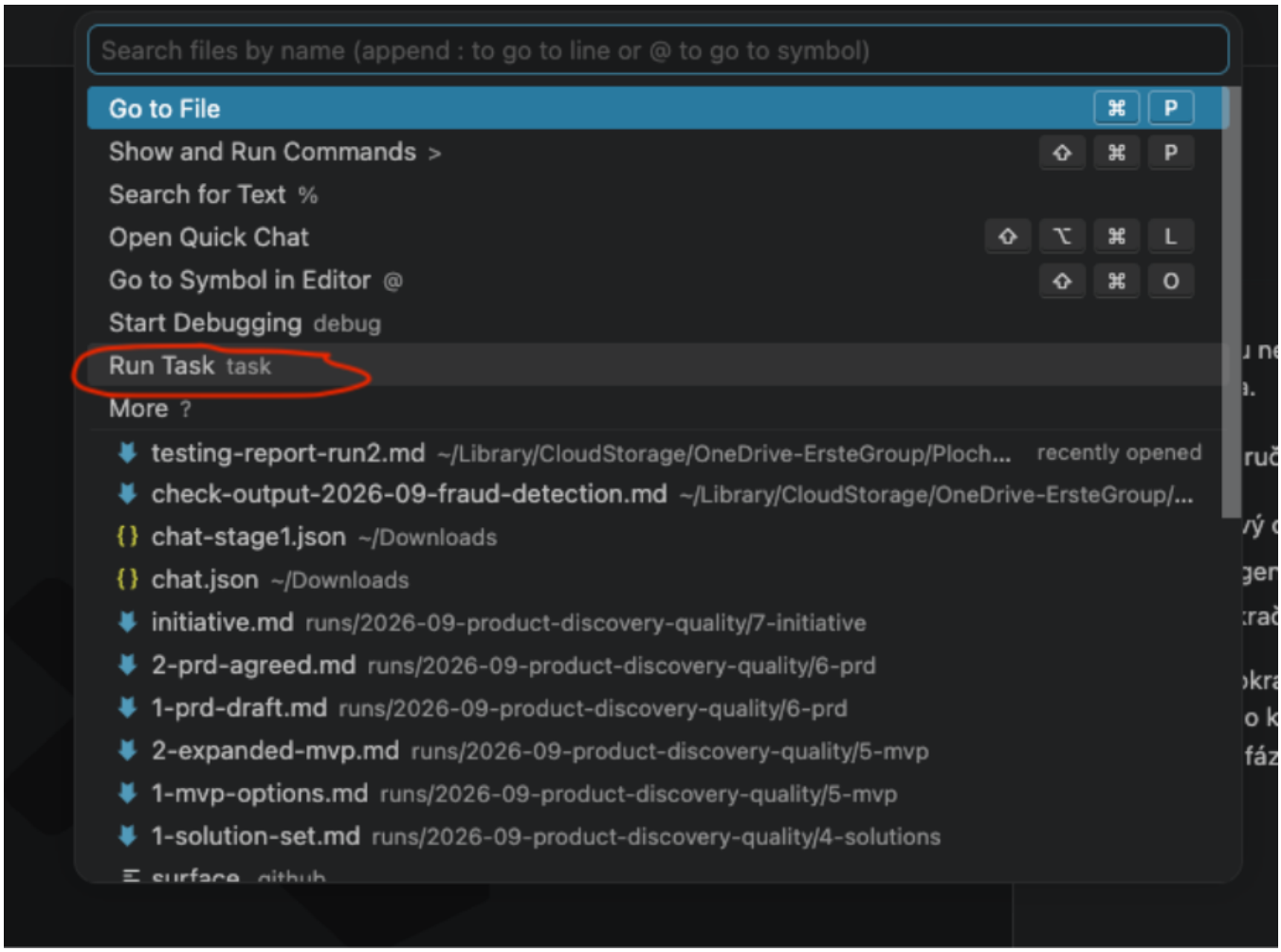
Running SPOCK Tasks

During the workflow, SPOCK may require human approval or confirmation before proceeding.

Opening the Run Task Command

1. Open the **Quick Access** command bar.
2. Search for: Run Task
3. Select **Run Task**.


SPOCK | Workflow 1.0
EXPLORER
SPOCK | WORKFLOW 1.0
.github
agents
instructions
know-how
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workflow-contracts
artifact-fields.yaml
copilot-instructions.md
could-not-verify.yaml
COVERAGE-CHECKS.md
last-task.md
OPERATING-A-RUN.md
runs-root
surface
.vscode
fixtures
governing-documents
Agent-Blueprint-Specification-v2.1.md
README.md
SPOCK-Pilot-Definition.md
Workflow-Blueprint-v1.42.md
runs/2026-09-product-discovery-q...
1-brief
2-problems
3-competitive-analysis
4-solutions
5-mvp
6-prd
7-initiative
read
records
superseded
README.md
RUN-STATE.md
sources.md
specifications
.gitignore
README.md
SETUP.md
OUTLINE
TIMELINE
Open Chat
Show All Commands
Go to File
PROBLEMS
OUTPUT
DEBUG CONSOLE
TERMINAL
PORTS
zsh
cen59347@MPMJ4QWMD8GF SPOCK | Workflow 1.0 %
CHAT
STAGE1
to už jsem udělala
Tuto fázi ale nesu ne já, ale Opportunity Designer, protože nese jiné know-how a je to nová nezávislá kontrola oproti té, co jsem právě dělala.
Jak začít, a doporučuji to takhle:
1. Otevřete nový chat.
2. Ve výběru agenta v chatovém okně zvolte Opportunity Designer.
3. Napište: pokračuj v runu 2026-09-product-discovery-quality.
Klidně můžete pokračovat i v tomhle okně a bude to fungovat. Ale nový chat je lepší ze dvou důvodů: nový agent začíná se znalostmi fáze, do které vstupuje, ne té, kterou opouštím. A nenese si s sebou nic z tohoto rozhovoru, což je to, co dělá kontrolu na další fázi skutečně nezávislou na těhle.
Tady končím.
když chci mluvit pouze česky, jak to zajistím, často odpovídáš anglicky
Completed 2 steps in 27s
Krátká odpověď: uvnitř tohohle SPOCKu language: cs na brief řídí jenom jazyk dokumentů, které se do runu zapisují — ne to, jakým jazykem s námi mluvím v chatu. Proto se stává, že dokument je česky, ale odpověď mi sklouzne do angličtiny; nic v běhu runu to nehlídá.
Dvě věci, které to reálně vyřeší:
1. Rychlé a spolehlivé pro tuhle relaci: napsat na začátku "od teď mluv jen česky" — to jsem dodržela po zbytek konverzace výše.
2. Trvalé napříč relacemi: přidat si osobní instrukční soubor do vaší uživatelské složky pro prompty ({{VSCODE_USER_PROMPTS_FOLDER}}), např. czech.instructions.md s applyTo: "**" a větou typu "Always respond in Czech, regardless of the language of the request." Tohle se pak natáhne do každé konverzace automaticky, bez ohledu na to, kterého agenta zrovna používáte.
Chcete, abych vám ten druhý soubor rovnou vytvořila?
2 files changed +161 -2
Keep
Undo
Says what state a run is actually in and what will move it. Reads the run record, the gate result and the failing task's out...
Workflow Support
Claude Sonnet 5
High 1M
Local
Default permissions


Search files by name (append : to go to line or @ to go to symbol)
Go to File ⌘ P
Show and Run Commands > ⇧ ⌘ P
Search for Text %
Open Quick Chat ⇧ ⌥ ⌘ L
Go to Symbol in Editor @ ⇧ ⌘ O
Start Debugging debug
Run Task task
More ?
testing-report-run2.md ~/Library/CloudStorage/OneDrive-ErsteGroup/Ploch... recently opened
check-output-2026-09-fraud-detection.md ~/Library/CloudStorage/OneDrive-ErsteGroup/...
chat-stage1.json ~/Downloads
chat.json ~/Downloads
initiative.md runs/2026-09-product-discovery-quality/7-initiative
2-prd-agreed.md runs/2026-09-product-discovery-quality/6-prd
1-prd-draft.md runs/2026-09-product-discovery-quality/6-prd
2-expanded-mvp.md runs/2026-09-product-discovery-quality/5-mvp
1-mvp-options.md runs/2026-09-product-discovery-quality/5-mvp
1-solution-set.md runs/2026-09-product-discovery-quality/4-solutions
surface .github

Executing a Task

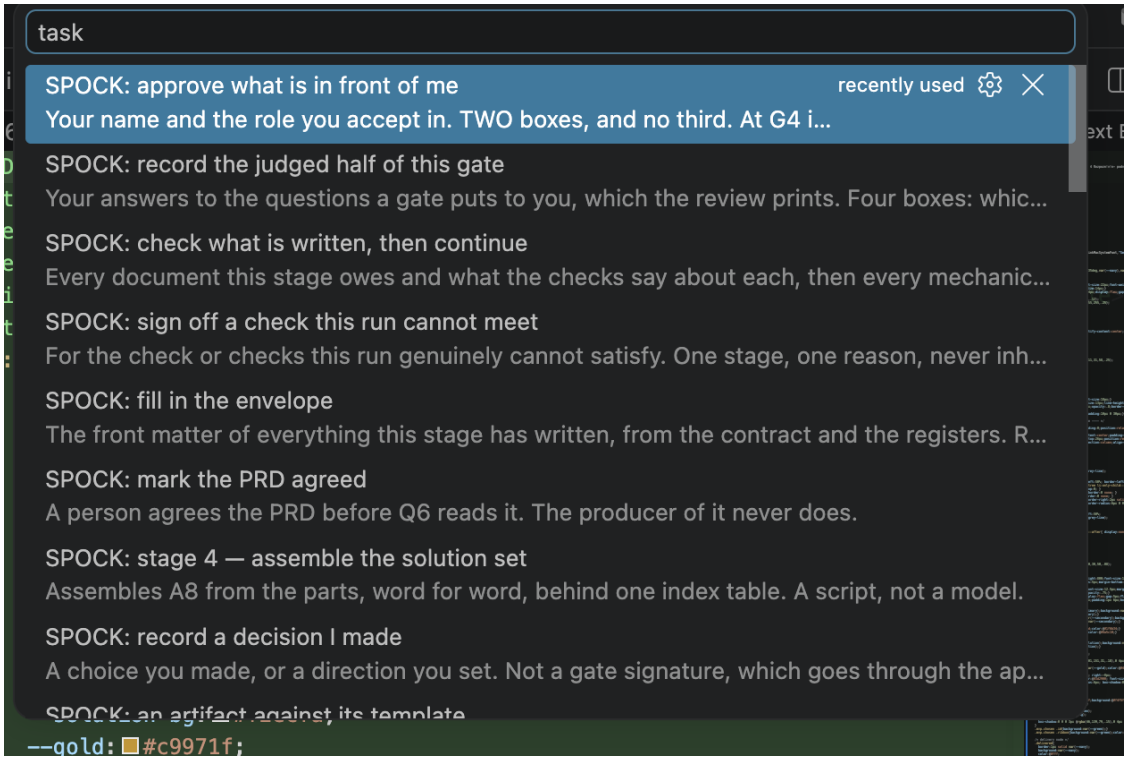
When the task input window appears:

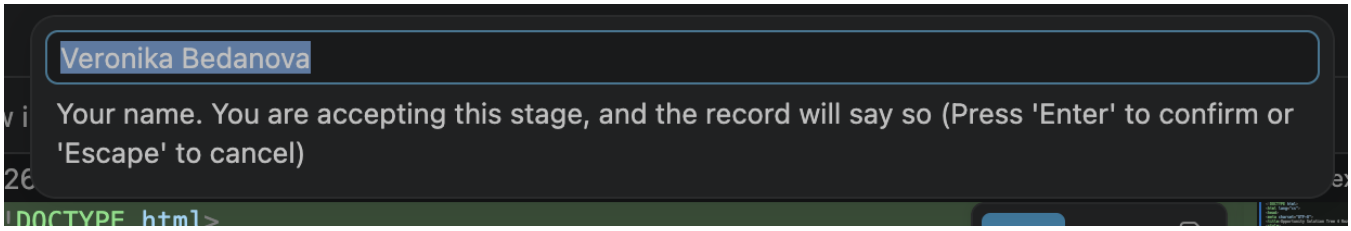
- Type the requested information.
- Press **Enter** to confirm.
- Press **Esc** to cancel.

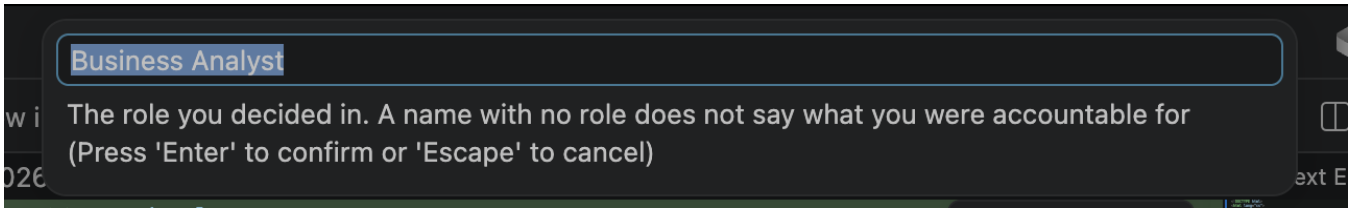
Example

A common task is: "SPOCK approve what is in front of me"

This is typically used as the main human sign-off action.





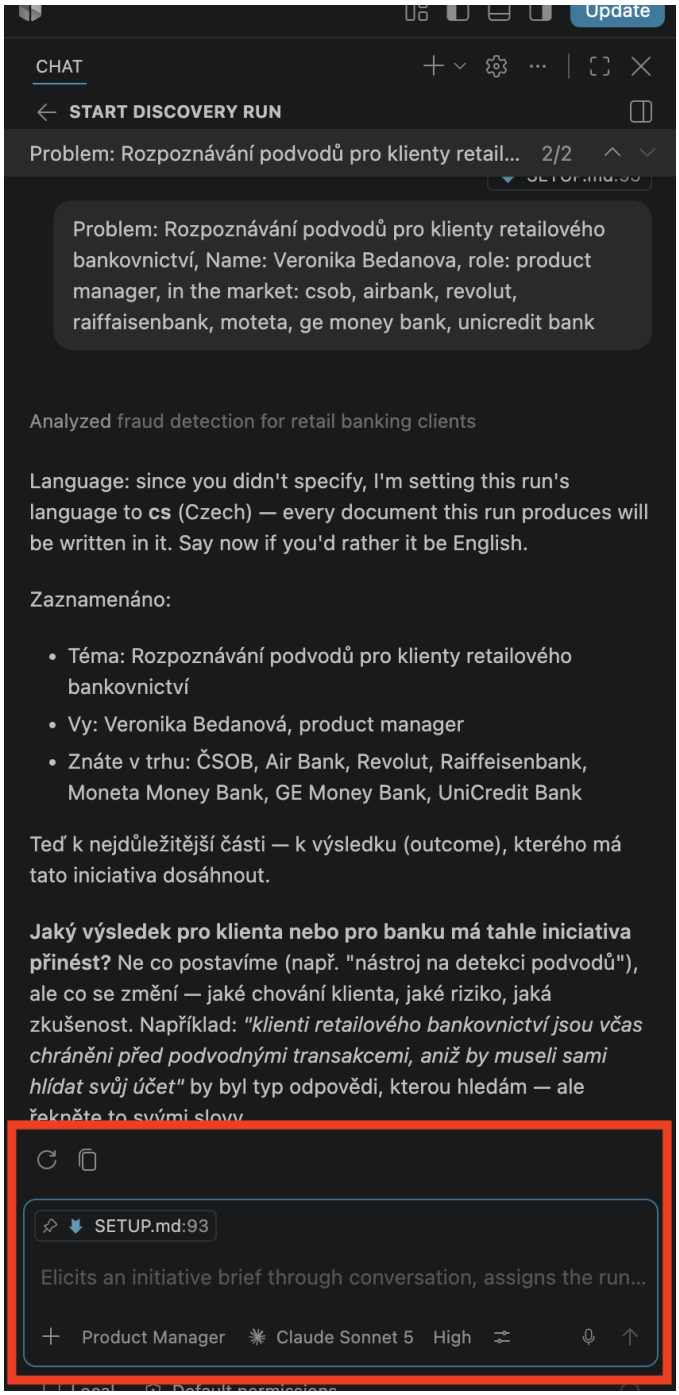


Working with the Main Chat Window

The primary area you'll use throughout the workflow is the SPOCK chat window.

The chat will:

- Guide you through each workflow step.
- Request approvals when required.
- Provide links to documents for review.
- Ask for iterations or feedback before moving to the next stage.



Reviewing Documents

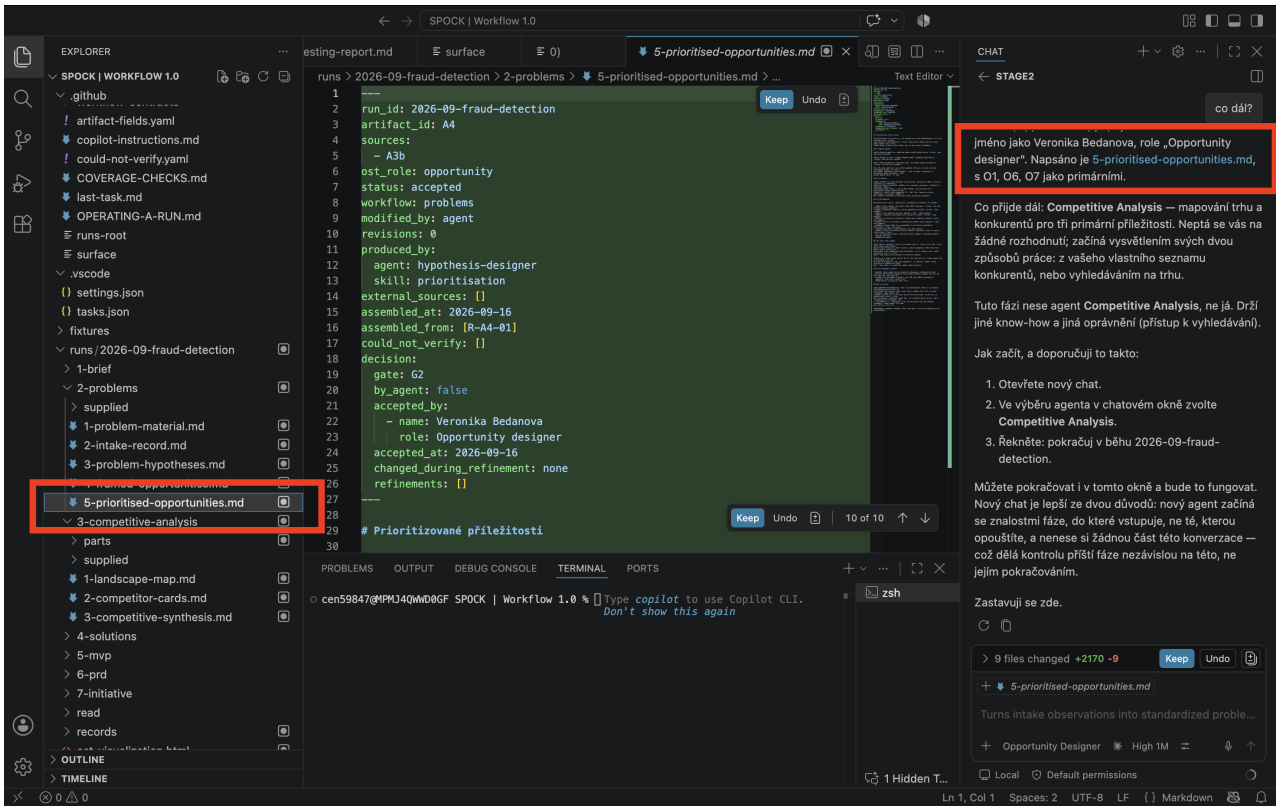
When SPOCK asks you to review a document:

Option 1: Open from Chat

Click the document link directly from the chat conversation.

Option 2: Open from the Repository

Navigate to the file in the repository tree on the left-hand side of VS Code.



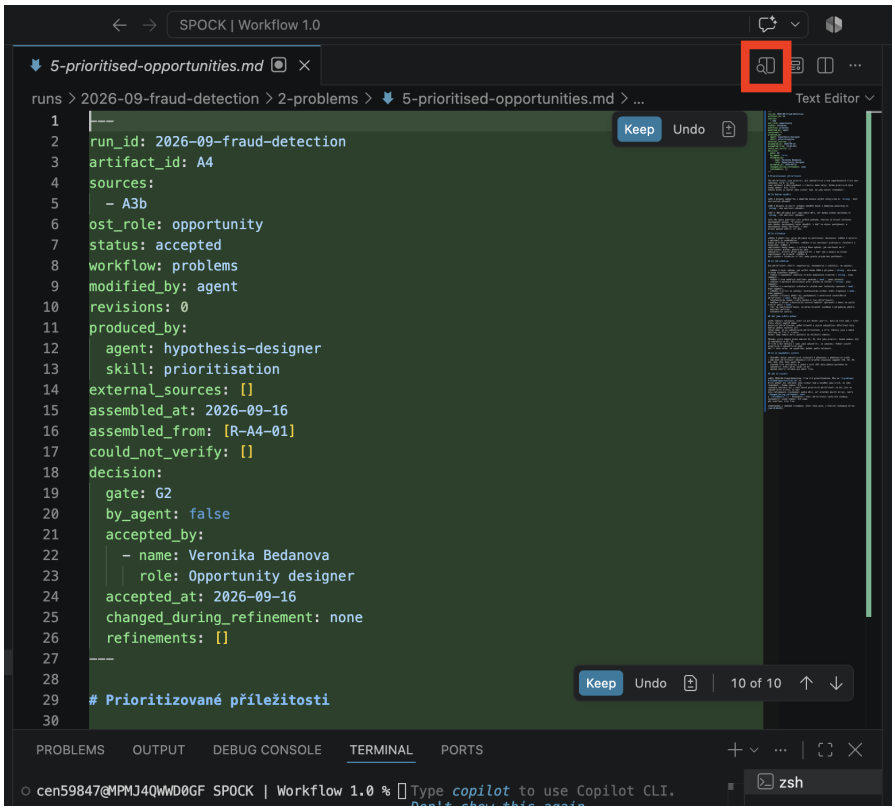
Using Document Preview

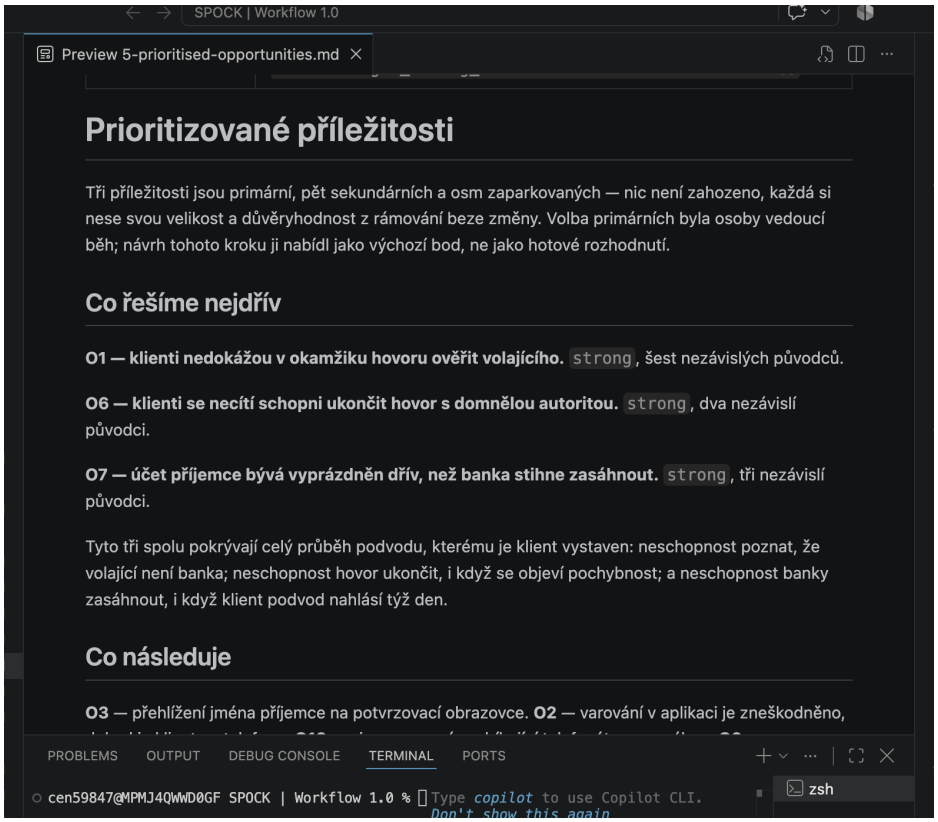
For a better reading experience:

1. Open the document.
2. Click **Open Preview to the Side**.
3. The document will open in a formatted preview view.

Benefits:

- Easier reading
- Better formatting
- Improved review experience during sign-off





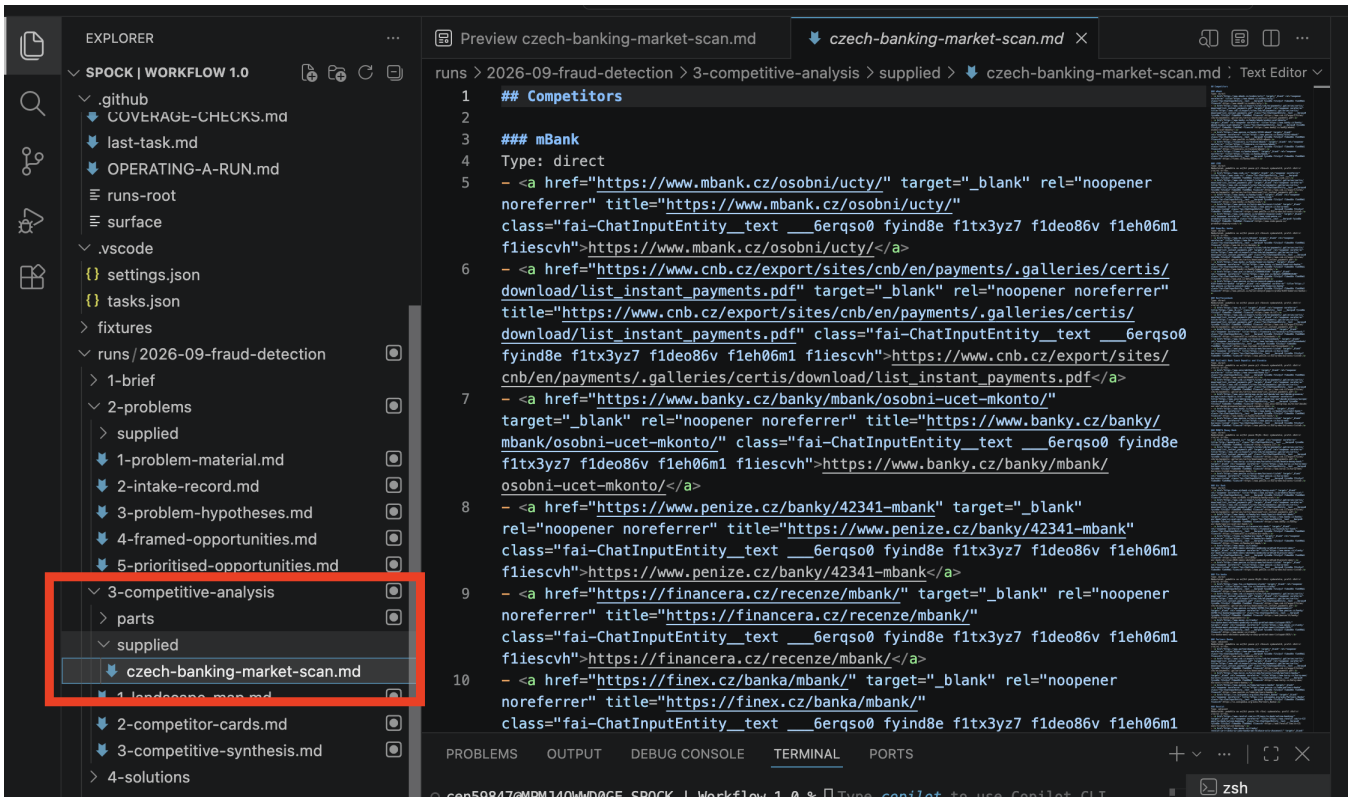
Adding a File to a Folder

During the workflow, an agent may ask you to add a file to a specific folder.

For example, the **Competitive Analyst** may ask you to add an `.md` file with links to competitors.

1. Find the folder requested by the agent in the repository tree on the left.
2. Drag and drop the prepared `.md` file into that folder.
3. Check that the file appears inside the folder.
4. Return to the SPOCK chat and continue the workflow.

The filename does not matter. The system recognizes that a file has been added to the folder.



Typical Workflow Summary

1. Verify prerequisites.
2. Open GitHub Copilot Chat.
3. Select the SPOCK agent.
4. Choose **Claude Sonnet 5**.
5. Check available credits.
6. Update the **surface** file (`unset copilot`).
7. Start the SPOCK workflow.
8. Use **Run Task** whenever human approval is required.
9. Review documents using **Open Preview to the Side**.
10. Approve, iterate, or reject content as requested by SPOCK.

Troubleshooting Checklist

If the workflow does not work as expected, verify:

- GitHub Copilot is signed in and active.
- Claude Sonnet 5 is selected.
- The `surface` file has been updated to `copilot`.
- Required REDIM roles have been approved.
- Node.js version 22+ is installed.
- The SPOCK repository is accessible locally.
- You have sufficient Copilot credits available.